

3. Project Design Phase

The design phase defines how the proposed solution will work inside ServiceNow. The incident lifecycle is designed as a controlled flow in which each stage has a specific purpose and responsible user or support team.

3.1 High-Level Incident Lifecycle

Incident Creation → Classification → Prioritization → Assignment → Investigation → Resolution → Closure

3.2 Incident Data Design

- Incident Number – unique identifier for each incident.
- Caller – user who reports or is affected by the issue.
- Short Description – brief summary of the incident.
- Description – detailed explanation of the issue.
- Category / Subcategory – classification of the issue.
- Impact – business or user impact.
- Urgency – required speed of response.
- Priority – calculated/assigned based on impact and urgency.
- Assignment Group – support team responsible for the incident.
- Assigned To – individual responsible for handling the incident.
- State – current stage of the incident lifecycle.
- Work Notes / Additional Comments – communication and investigation history.
- Resolution Information – details of how the incident was resolved.

3.3 Automation Design

- Use ServiceNow workflow/automation capabilities to support lifecycle activities.
- Route incidents to appropriate support groups.
- Use conditions to control actions at different stages.
- Notify relevant users or support teams when required.
- Use knowledge articles when a known solution is available.
- Initiate or associate a change when the incident requires a controlled change.

3.4 Security Design

ServiceNow roles and access controls are considered in the design so that users can perform only the activities appropriate to their responsibilities.